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10 Key Milestones That Shaped the History of Artificial Intelligence

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While artificial intelligence (AI) is now deeply embedded in our everyday lives, its roots go back several decades. The progress we see today is the result of a long and continuous evolution.

To better understand this technological revolution, let's explore **ten major milestones in the history of AI**—moments that not only marked breakthroughs in computing, but also redefined the way we interact with machines.

From early theories of neural networks to game-changing innovations in **natural language processing** and **facial**



Want to learn more about AI ?

Ask Mona offers tailor-made training programs to help culture, education and tourism professionals understand, master, and apply generative AI

recognition, these key dates highlight how **AI has influenced diverse fields** like strategic games, medicine, and consumer robotics.

in their work. Whether you're just starting out or aiming to go further, we adapt to your needs.

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1943 – McCulloch and Pitts lay the foundations of neural networks

Warren McCulloch and Walter Pitts publish *"A Logical Calculus of Ideas Immanent in Nervous Activity,"* proposing the first theoretical model of **artificial neural networks**. Their work simulates how the human brain functions and introduces the idea of connecting artificial neurons to perform logical operations.

1951 – SNARC, the first neural network computer

Mathematician Marvin Minsky and neurophysiologist Warren McCulloch build the **Stochastic Neural Analog Reinforcement Calculator (SNARC)**. Though basic by today's standards, SNARC represents the first real-world attempt to implement neural networks in a machine.

1956 – The Dartmouth Conference officially launches AI research

Organized by John McCarthy, Marvin Minsky, Nathaniel Rochester, and Claude Shannon, this landmark event brings researchers together to explore the possibility of creating **artificial intelligence**. It formally establishes AI as a distinct field of study.

1957 – The Perceptron: a neural network that learns

Frank Rosenblatt develops the **Perceptron**, a basic neural network capable of **learning to recognize patterns**. Although limited in capacity, it proves that machines can adapt and improve through experience—a major step in **machine learning**.

1965 – ELIZA, the first natural language chatbot

Joseph Weizenbaum creates **ELIZA**, a program that simulates human conversation through **natural language processing**. The chatbot surprises the public by showing how machines can interact in a human-like manner, paving the way for future conversational AI.

1997 – IBM's Deep Blue beats the world chess champion

Deep Blue, a supercomputer built by IBM, defeats reigning world chess champion **Garry Kasparov**. This historic victory demonstrates that machines can outperform humans in highly complex and strategic domains.

2002 – iRobot launches Roomba, an AI-powered household robot

Roomba, the first widely available **AI-powered robotic vacuum**, enters homes around the world. It marks a milestone in **AI for daily life**, offering autonomous functionality for everyday household tasks.

2014 – Facebook develops DeepFace, an advanced facial recognition system

DeepFace is Facebook's facial recognition software that achieves **near-**

human accuracy. This breakthrough in **computer vision** raises both technological excitement and public debate over ethics and privacy.

2020 – OpenAI releases GPT-3, a leap in natural language understanding

GPT-3 (Generative Pre-trained Transformer 3), developed by OpenAI, is one of the most powerful **language models** ever created. It significantly advances how machines can generate, interpret, and respond to human language—fueling new applications in chatbots, content generation, and beyond.

2021 – DeepMind solves the protein folding problem

Google's AI lab **DeepMind** cracks one of the biggest puzzles in biology: protein folding. The implications for **medical research and drug discovery** are enormous, showcasing AI's ability to solve scientific problems with real-world impact.

By retracing these **10 key dates in the evolution of artificial intelligence**, we see how visionary ideas have gradually become concrete innovations—shaping not only the tech industry but our everyday relationship with machines.

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